

Inoguchi - 2

Japan  
Election  
Pledges

1972 GENERAL ELECTION CAMPAIGN PLEDGES

1960-1980

LIBERAL DEMOCRATIC PARTY (LDP)

51:42

1. Diplomacy and Defense

1) We will work to promote friendship and peace with the nations of the world. 2) We will maintain the foundation of Japan-U.S. cooperation and improve the economic relations between the two countries. 3) We will develop friendship with China and conclude a Japan-China peace and friendship treaty. 4) We will deepen mutual understanding and work to develop friendship with the countries of Asia. 5) We will realize the return of the Northern Territories and strive to conclude a Japan-Soviet peace treaty. 6) We will expand economic cooperation with developing countries. 7) In order to defend our country in the current situation where the international situation is neither stable nor free of tension, we will continue to support the security system with the U.S. and maintain an effective defense so that we are able to prevent an invasion. 8) It is necessary to continue to carry out the supplying of our defense forces from a long-term point of view. Thus, we have decided on the Fourth Five-Year Defense Plan.

## 2. Restructuring the Country

1) We will carry out the restructuring of Japanese archipelago in order to correct the excessive concentration of population and industry, to solve simultaneously the problems of overcrowding and depopulation, and to build a land that has good living and is free of pollution. 2) Through a long-range overall plan, we will provide social capital, such as Shinkansen lines nation-wide, highways and other roads, the Aomori-Hakodate tunnel, bridges connecting Honshu and Shikoku, and a nation-wide information network. 3) We will redistribute factories from overcrowded areas to specially designated areas. In these cases, we will study measures to prevent pollution. 4) We will redevelop the metropolitan areas and construct 250 thousand cities in the the provinces that will be fully equipped with a living environment and cultural facilities. 5) We will establish and effectively put into effect a plan for land use; and, in order to restrict speculative land dealings, we will investigate tax measures and policies such as a system of reporting land transactions.

## 3. National Life

1) We will carry out a 500 billion yen tax cut, by significantly raising the minimum income tax and resident tax, by lowering the tax of retirement allowances, and by establishing a system of compensation to workers in small scale businesses. 2) In order to stabilize prices, we will push for stronger policies

to stabilize food prices, for strong policies to hold down land prices, for checks on public utility charges, for the rationalization of distribution stages of wholesale and retail markets in metropolitan areas, and for guarantees for fair trade transactions. 3) We will push for construction of comfortable housing equipped with at least one room per person. 4) We will strongly push for policies to preserve the living environment, to prevent pollution, and to promote traffic safety.

#### 4. Social Welfare

1) We will raise old age pensions to 10 thousand yen, contributory national pensions for couples to 50 thousand yen a month, welfare pensions to 50 thousand, as well as raise handicapped pensions for both mother and child. 2) We will realize a sliding scale sale for each of the various types of mutual aid pensions. 3) We will provide free medical care to those who are over 65 years of age and bed-ridden, plus strengthen other types of old age welfare. 4) We will improve survivor pensions and their benefits. 5) We will accommodate all those who are seriously handicapped physically or mentally. 6) We will provide free medical care to those with incurable diseases and those afflicted with unusual diseases. 7) In order to ensure public medical care, we will improve treatment for those practicing medicine and provide free medical checkups for pregnant women and infants. 8) We will work to popularize the five day work week. 9) We will maintain the waterworks system and the waste treatment

facilities. 10) We will establish a system to protect from disasters those who are commuting to work.

## 5. Political Position

1) We will clarify political responsibility and carry out politics of decision and implementation. 2) We will consider dialogues with the public and talks with other political parties as the key to success in political management. 3) We expect to establish politics led by political parties with the backing of the people. 4) We will maintain law and order and completely eliminate violence. 5) We will reinvestigate the administrative structure that spans the country and regions and strive for its simplification and rationalization. 6) We will strengthen the Cabinet's overall planning and coordinative functions. 7) We will realize an election system based on political parties at the same time as strengthening regulations dealing with political funds. 8) We will correct the conspicuous imbalance in the number of Diet seats.

## JAPAN SOCIALIST PARTY (JSP)

52:72

### 1. Diplomacy and Defense

With the restoration of ties between Japan and China we will settle the accounts of cold war diplomacy and develop a diplomacy of peaceful coexistence. We will work to ease tensions in Asia by refusing to cooperate with the American war of aggression on Vietnam, to discontinue the Fourth Five-Year Defense